



ASTER RELAY

NIGHTLINE / MIDNIGHT INDIGO / PIXEL-LIGHT / RESTRAINED
NEON

Aster Relay is a quiet, expressive identity for a tech-education collective: civic-minded, practical, protective, and just a little more alive at the edges.

This revision starts from the uploaded **Midnight Galaxy** reference and pulls it into a distinct sibling system with deeper indigo fields, cleaner violet structure, tiny graffiti traces, pixel affection, and a super subtle neon signal. *The base stays readable.*

Learn quietly. Build carefully. Protect each other.

page 1

Stance and design philosophy

What it is

A mixed-gender tech collective identity built for workshops, documentation, release notes, letters, social cards, and tools related to practical self-protection and mutual literacy.

What it is not

Not tactical cosplay. Not glossy startup futurism. Not nostalgia merch. The system remains calm and exact even when it carries a little hand-made residue.

The Nightline edge

Graffiti whisper: slanted underlines, spray-soft traces, tiny tags.

Pixel affection: stepped stars, dither fields, visible grid logic.

Neon punch: cyan or magenta only as pulse colors, never as a flood.



Proof words

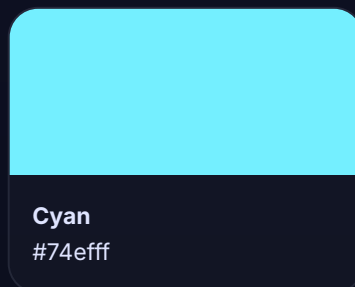
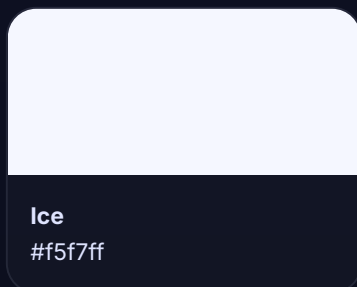
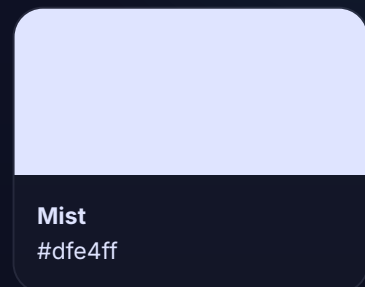
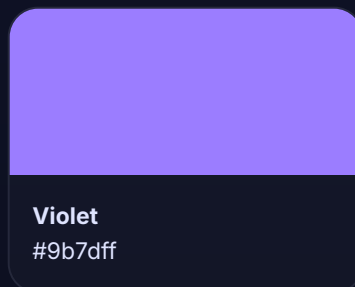
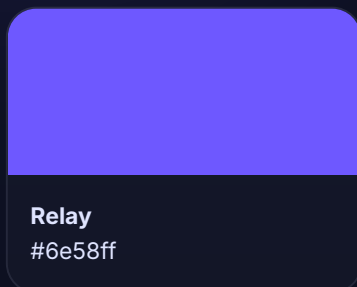
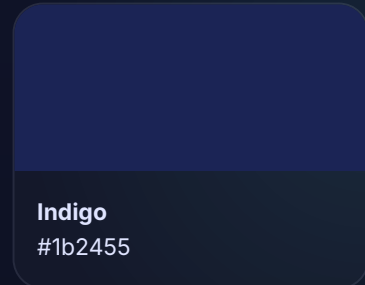
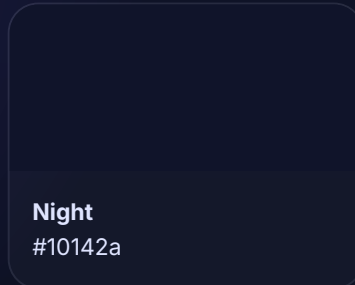
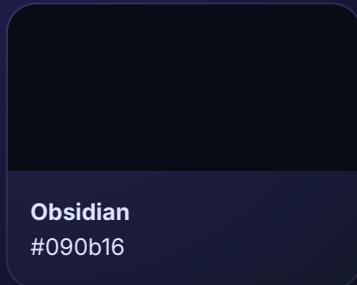
steady · literate · protective · lived-in · non-performative

Writing posture

Write like a capable peer. Use concrete nouns and verbs. Let posters carry attitude; let docs carry trust. One sharp phrase is enough.

SYSTEM

Palette, type, and shape



Typography

Display: Inter Display Bold

Body: Inter / FreeSans

Mono: DejaVu Sans Mono

Prose width: 72ch · comment
wrap: 88 chars

Shape language

Rounded panels with stepped interruptions. Circular relay motifs anchored by square pixel cues. Glow is a hint, not a texture blanket.

IDENTITY

Logo and icon direction



Mark

The symbol blends relay geometry, orbital focus, and 8-bit star nodes. It stays name-agnostic, which makes it useful for configurable branding.

Use

Prefer the mark on app surfaces, profile images, stickers, and favicon-like contexts. Use the lockup for letters, decks, websites, and release covers.

ICON SET / PIXEL-LIGHT

security, workshop, mesh, key, beacon, notebook



SHIELD



WORKSHOP



MESH



KEY



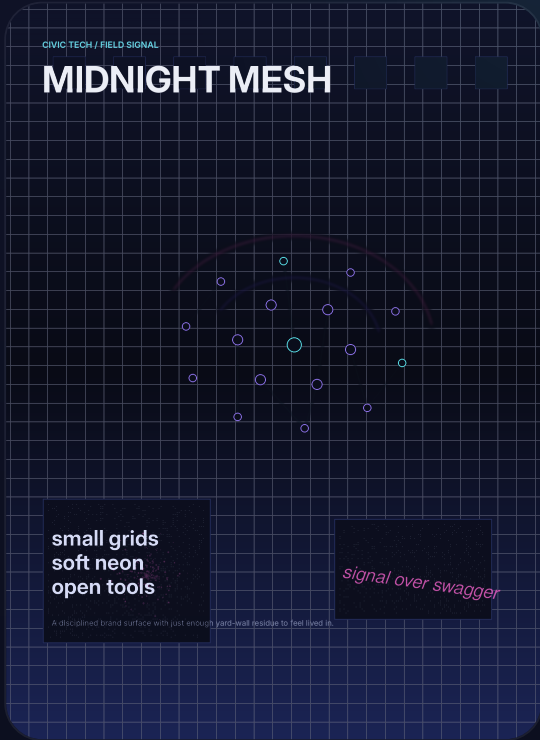
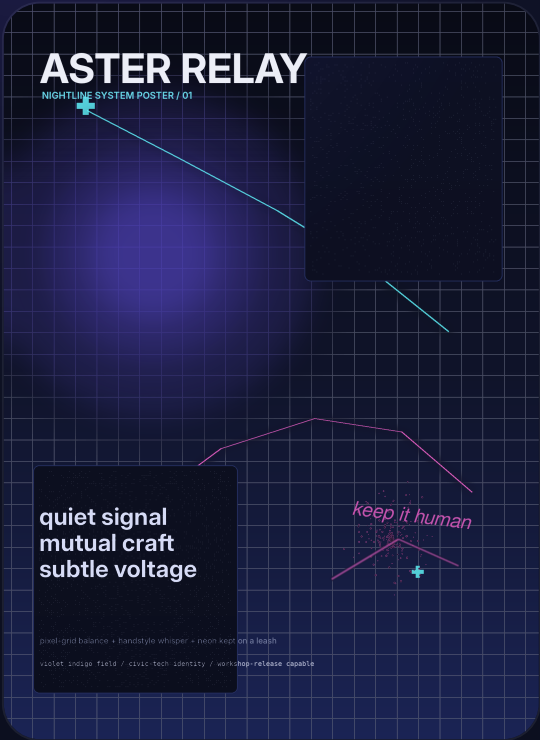
BEACON



NOTEBOOK

ART DIRECTION

Poster, social, and wallpaper language



Aster Relay / art direction

APPLICATION

Documents, code, and tooling

Surface	Guideline
Letterhead	Formal white page, violet rule, one stepped signal accent only.
Docs CSS	Dark indigo reading surface with controlled callout glow and pixel note markers.
Markdown	72ch prose; headings direct; bright accents only for real emphasis.
LaTeX	Configurable macros for name and descriptor; readable headings and code blocks.
Source comments	Explain intent and assumptions; avoid swagger and obvious narration.

Preferred subject format

Aster Relay — workshop invite —
browser safety clinic

Field note — account recovery
checklist

Code header pattern

```
// Aster Relay / field  
note  
// Purpose: ...  
// Risk: ...
```

Name can be swapped without breaking the system

Files added

```
config/brand.json  
scripts/apply_brand.py  
templates/configurable/*
```

Change the collective name, slug, line, domain, email, and document prefix in one place.

How to use it

1. Edit the JSON config.
2. Run the script.
3. Use the rendered outputs in generated/.

The symbol system stays stable while the naming layer adapts.

Why this matters

Collectives evolve. Names change. Programs split or merge. Making the naming layer configurable protects the investment in the visual system and keeps the pack reusable for future iterations.

CLOSING

Use the edge sparingly

The strongest version of this identity is still quiet. The graffiti trace should feel remembered, not performed. The pixel language should feel loved, not gimmicky. The neon should feel like a pulse, not a flood.

That balance is what keeps the system modern, readable, and durable across code, docs, letters, sites, and collective releases.

ASTER RELAY
practical privacy and mutual tech literacy

Learn quietly. Build carefully. Protect each other.

page 8